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UNDERSTANDING THE SELF

I. The Self from Various Perspectives



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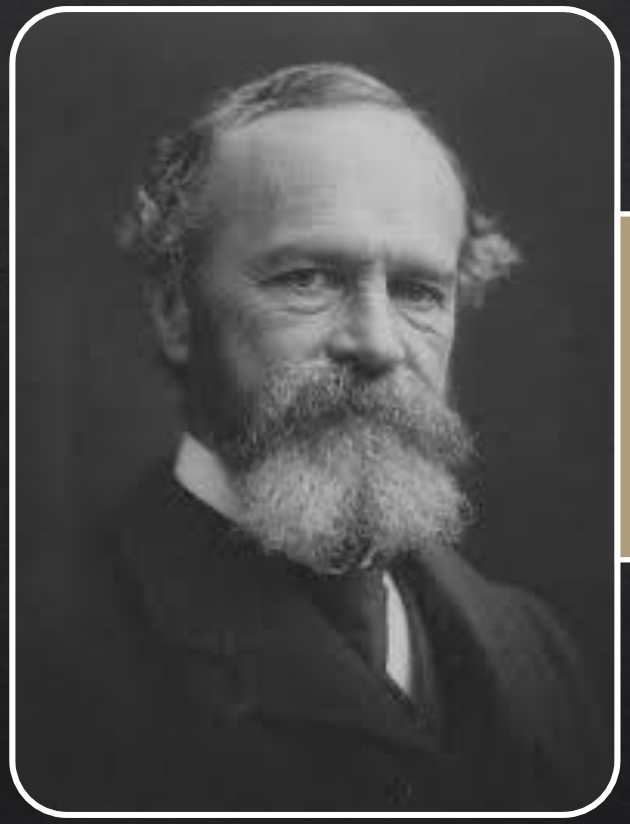
The Psychological Perspective of the Self

Learning Outcomes:

- Define and describe the different concepts of the self in the psychological perspective
- Explain how the concepts of the self influence behaviors
- Apply the concepts of the self to develop self-awareness and self-understanding

- William James: I-self and Me-Self
- Carl Rogers: Real Self and Ideal Self
- Donald Winnicott: True Self versus False Self
- Rita Carter & David Lester: Multiple versus Unified Self
- Albert Bandura: Proactive and Agentic
- Sigmund Freud: Theory of Personality
- Carl Jung: Self as Central Archetype
- Erik Erickson: Psychosocial Theory

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William James:

I-self and Me-Self

WILLIAM JAMES' CONCEPT OF SELF

SELF AS HAVING TWO (2) ASPECTS:

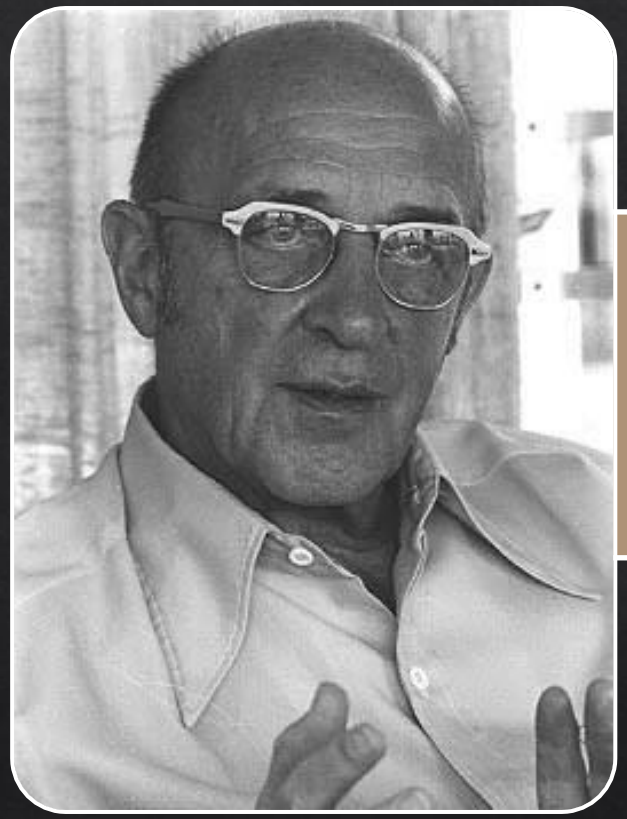
I-SELF

- Refers to the self that knows who he/she is
- Thinking, acting, and feeling self
- Reflects the soul of a person or what is now thought of as the mind and is called the pure ego

ME-SELF

- The empirical self
- Refers to describing the person's personal experiences and further divided into sub-categories:
  1. Material Self
  2. Social Self
  3. Spiritual Self

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Carl Rogers:

Real Self and Ideal Self

THE SELF CONCEPT THEORY: REAL AND IDEAL SELF

- Self-concept refers to the image of oneself.
- Psychologist Carl Rogers defined the self as a flexible and changing perception of personal identity.
- He emphasized the importance of free will and psychological growth.

THE SELF CONCEPT THEORY: REAL AND IDEAL SELF

- The self develops from interactions with significant people and self-awareness.
- According to Rogers, human beings are always striving for self-fulfillment or self-actualization.
- When the needs of the self are denied, severe anxiety may result.

THE SELF CONCEPT THEORY: REAL AND IDEAL SELF

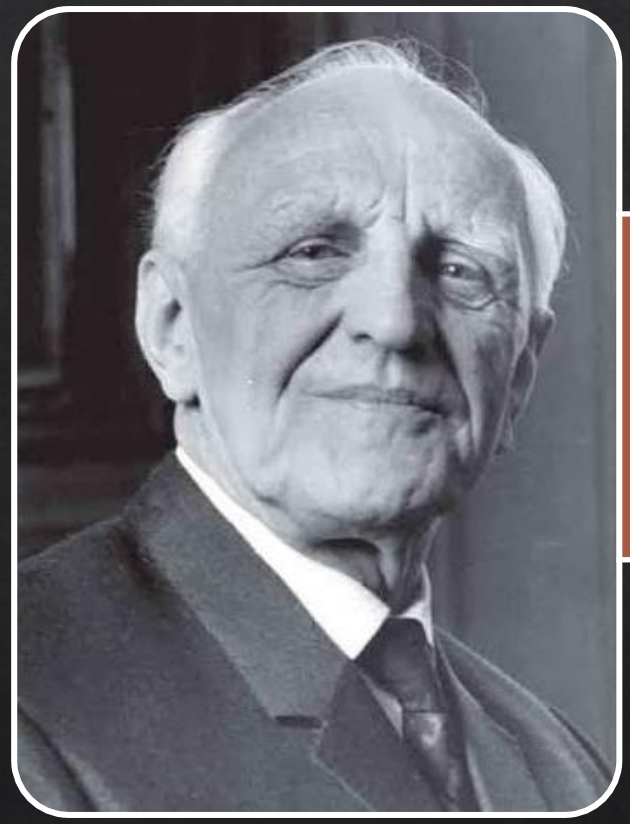
- Central to achieving self-actualization is the development of self-concept.
- Rogers suggest that there are two components of self-concept:
    1. Real Self
    2. Ideal Self

THE SELF CONCEPT THEORY: REAL AND IDEAL SELF

REAL SELF	IDEAL SELF
consists of all ideas including the awareness of "what I am" and "what can I do".	is the person's conception of what one should be or wanted to be that includes one's goals and ambitions in life

- **The closer (congruent) the ideal self is to the real self, the more fulfilled and happy the individual becomes. The farther (incongruent) the ideal self is to the real self leads to unhappy and dissatisfied person.**

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Donald Winnicott:

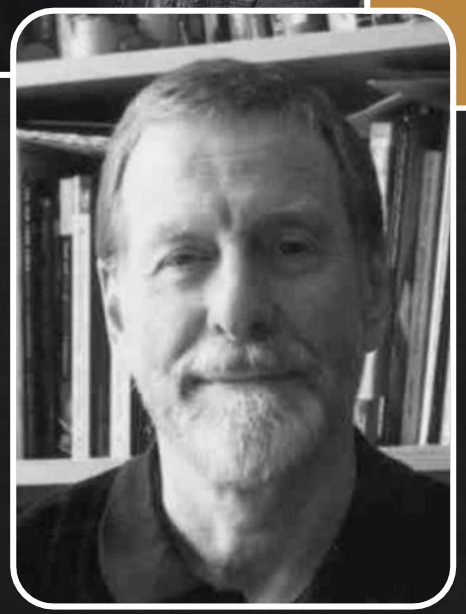
True Self vs False Self

TRUE vs FALSE SELF

- Winnicott suggest that the self is composed of “True” and “False” self.
- The function of the false self is to hide and protect the true self.
- The false self is our social identity.
- People tend to display a false self to impress others.
- The self can change depending on situations.
- Have you ever experienced hiding your true self?

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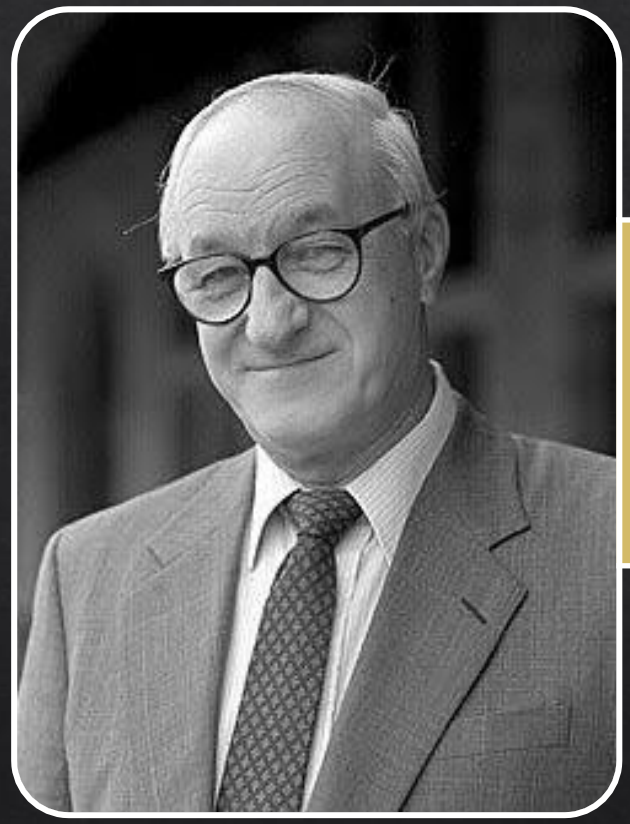
Rita Carter & David Lester:

Multiple vs Unified Self

MULTIPLE vs UNIFIED SELF

- Self understanding in adolescents also includes conceptualizing the self as multiple or unified.
- The construction of multiple selves varies across different roles and relationships.
- Coping with different selves constitutes a formidable task among adolescents.
- These challenges contribute heavily to the young person's struggle for a unified self.

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Albert Bandura:

Proactive and Agentic

PROACTIVE AND AGENTIC SELF

- For Bandura, humas have the ability to act and make things happen.
- In his theory of the self, people are viewed as proactive agents of experiences.
- Humans are producers of their life circumstance not just products of them.
- According to his social cognitive theory: views people as agents (originators) of experience, not just reactive (reactors).

PROACTIVE AND AGENTIC SELF

FOUR (4) AGENTIC PERSPECTIVES :

1. INTENTIONALITY

- Intentionality refers to acts done intentionally. People are capable of doing things intentionally.
- Enables us to behave with purpose; everything we do has a purpose.

2. FORETHOUGHT

- Allows us to anticipate outcomes; people are capable of expecting outcomes and consequences of prospective actions.

PROACTIVE AND AGENTIC SELF

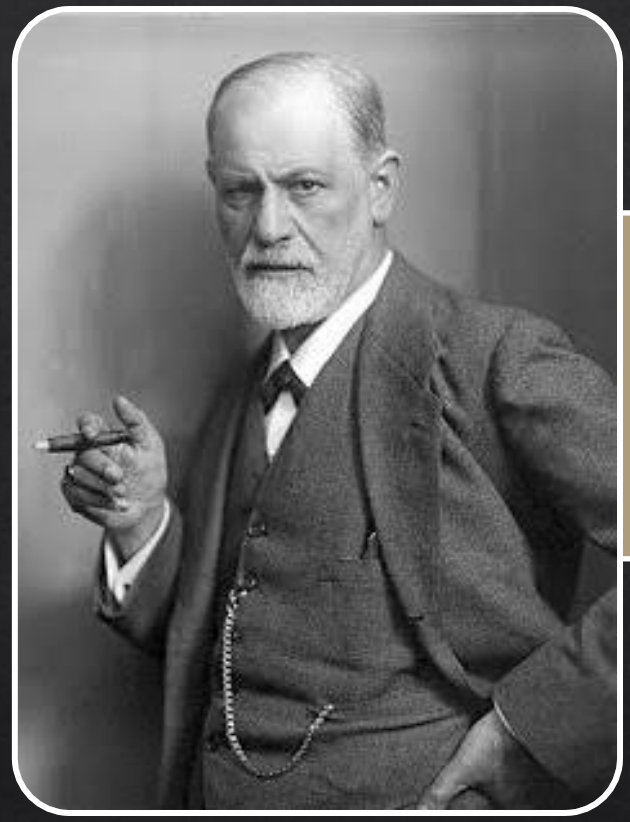
3. SELF-REACTIVENESS

- It enables the person to make choices and choose appropriate courses of actions. We can react to a certain situation and be motivated to regulate our actions.

4. SELF-REFLECTIVENESS

- We can reflect our thoughts, actions, and behaviors and make needed modifications.

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Sigmund Freud:

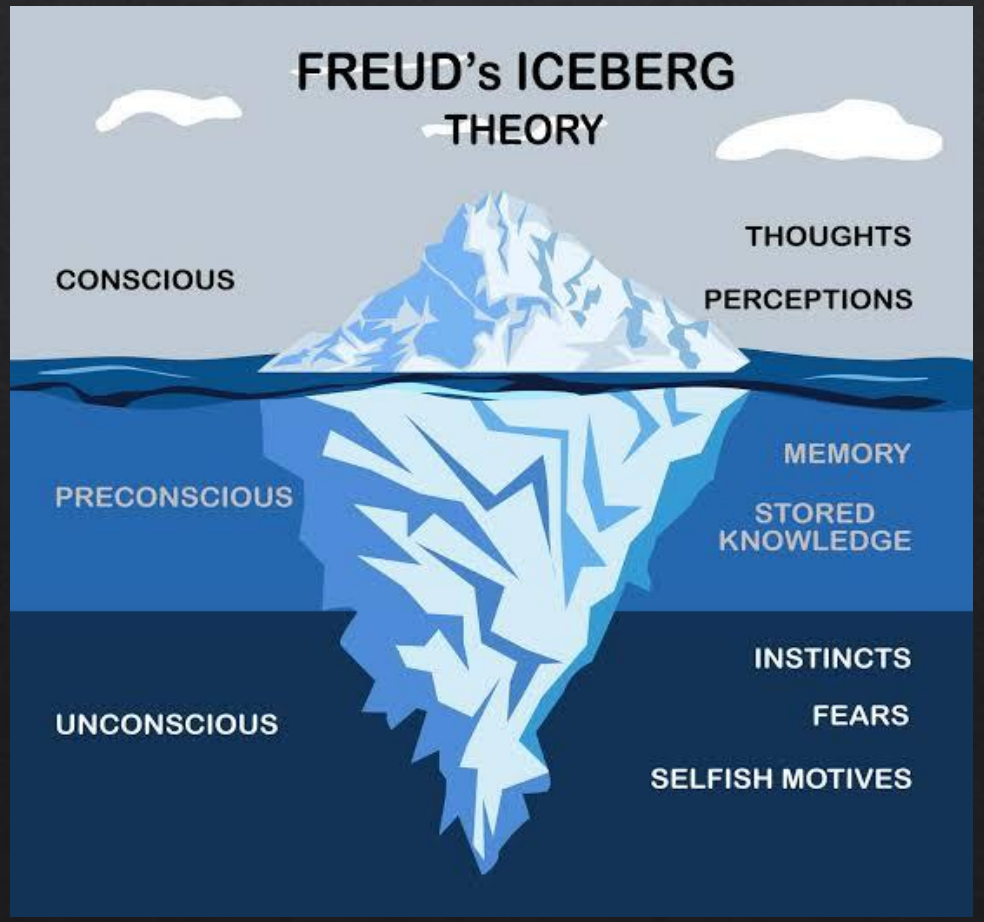
Theory of Personality

FREUD's LEVELS OF CONSCIOUSNESS

- Sigmund Freud divided the human mind into levels of awareness and structural parts of personality that constantly interact to shape behavior.
- He compared the mind to an iceberg. Only a small part is visible above the water, while a massive portion remains hidden beneath.

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LEVELS OF CONSCIOUSNESS
(The Iceberg Model)

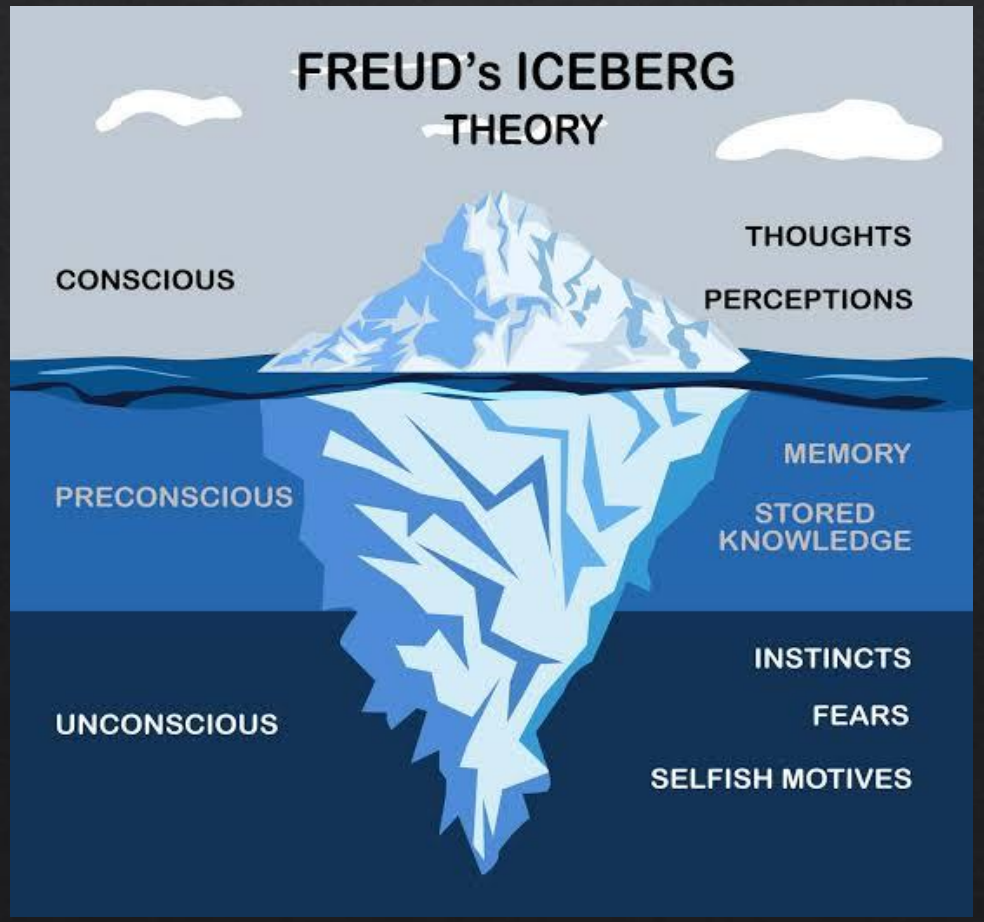


CONSCIOUS

- This is everything you are aware of right now, including your current thoughts, feelings, and surroundings.

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LEVELS OF CONSCIOUSNESS
(The Iceberg Model)

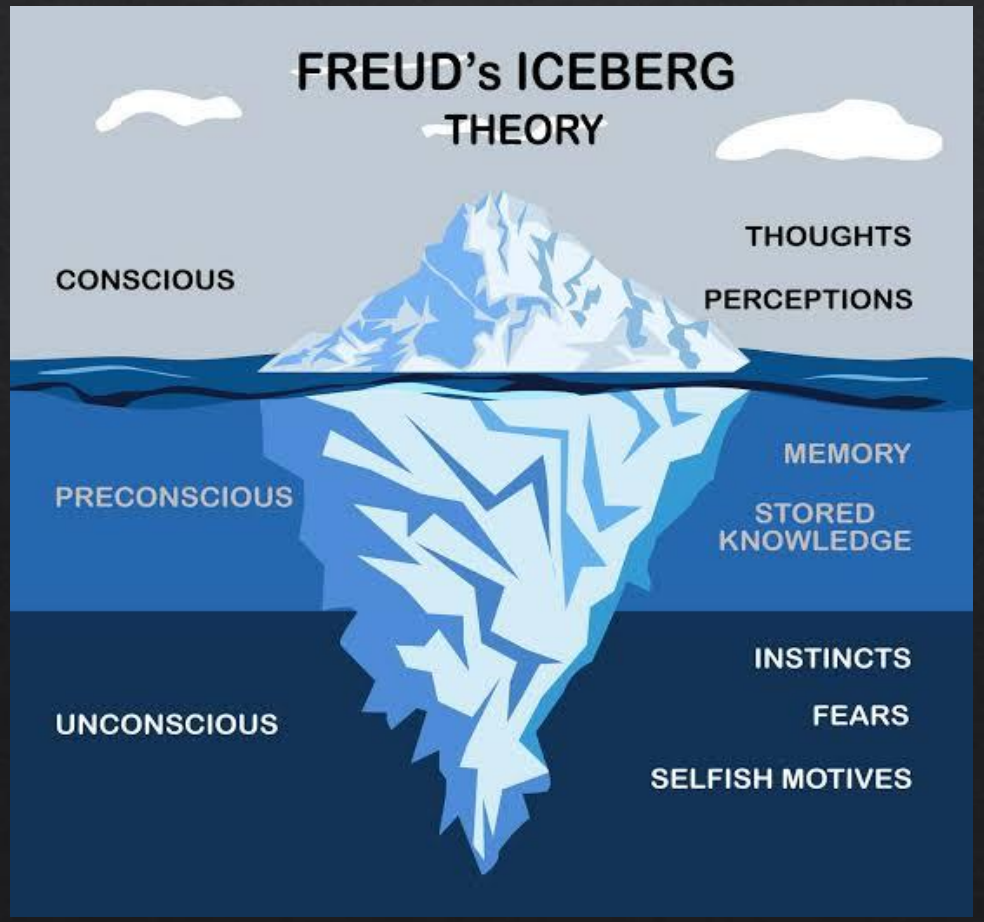


PRECONSCIOUS

- This level holds information you are not thinking about at this exact moment, but you can easily pull into your awareness (e.g. remembering what you ate for breakfast).

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LEVELS OF CONSCIOUSNESS
(The Iceberg Model)



UNCONSCIOUS

- This is a deep, hidden layer of the mind filled with primal urges, painful memories, and hidden desires that you cannot see, but which still drive your actions.

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PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY
(Theory of Personality)

- **According to Freud, there are three (3) structures of personality:**

ID



EGO

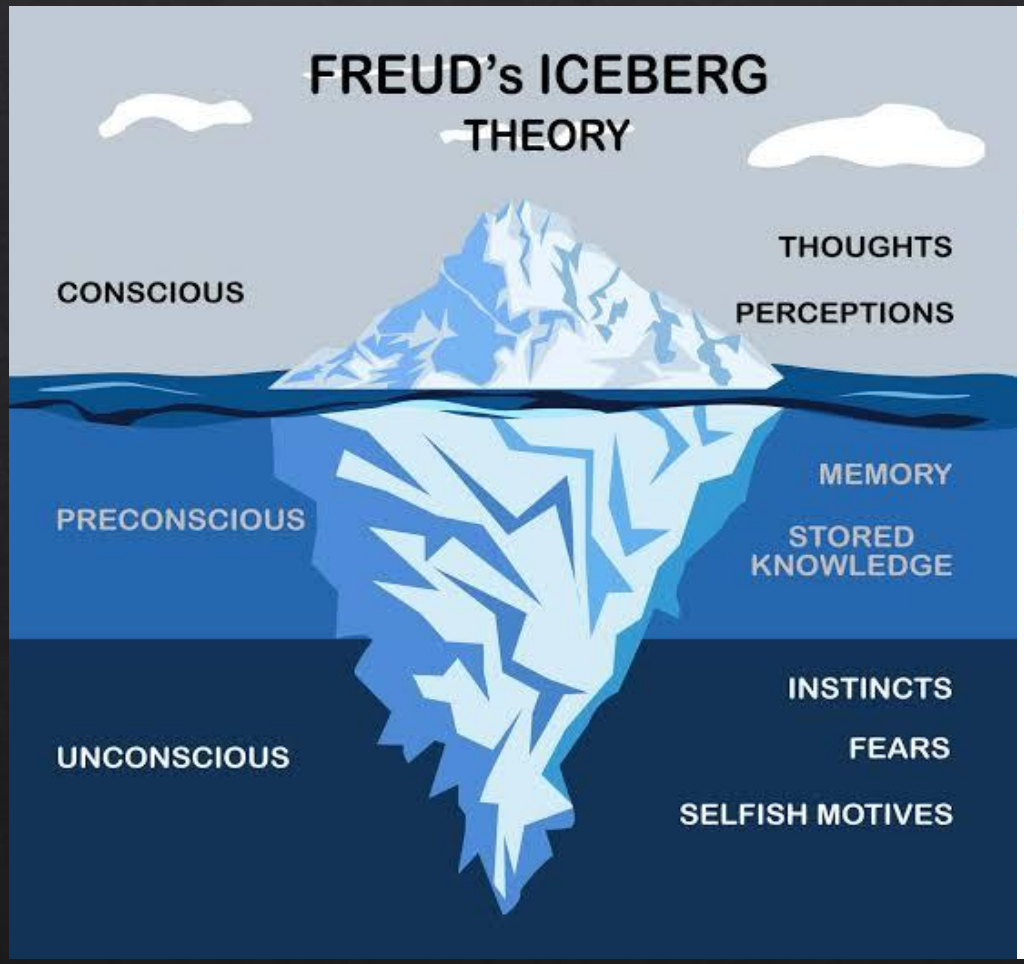


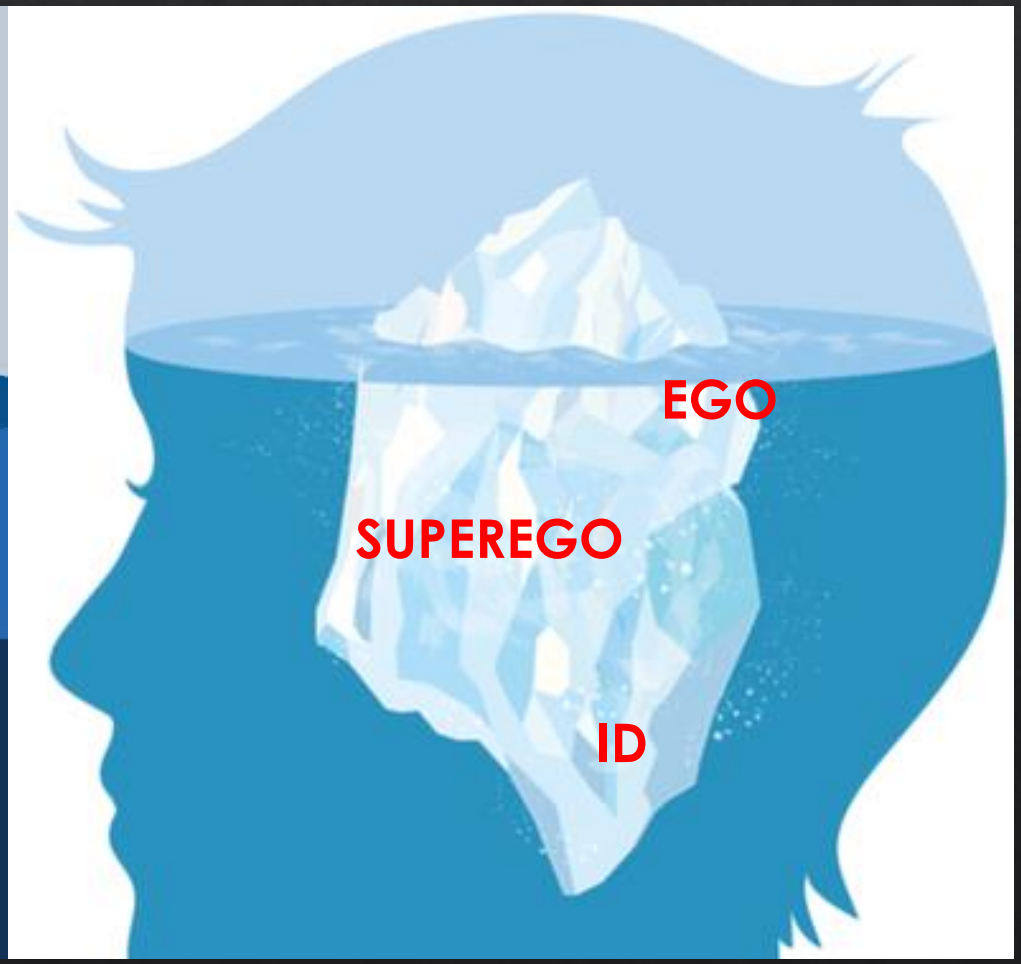
SUPEREGO



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Levels of Consciousness (The Iceberg Model)





PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY

- The id is the pleasure-seeking side, immature, impulsive, child-like, and cannot delay gratification.
- It has no regard of others and the law.



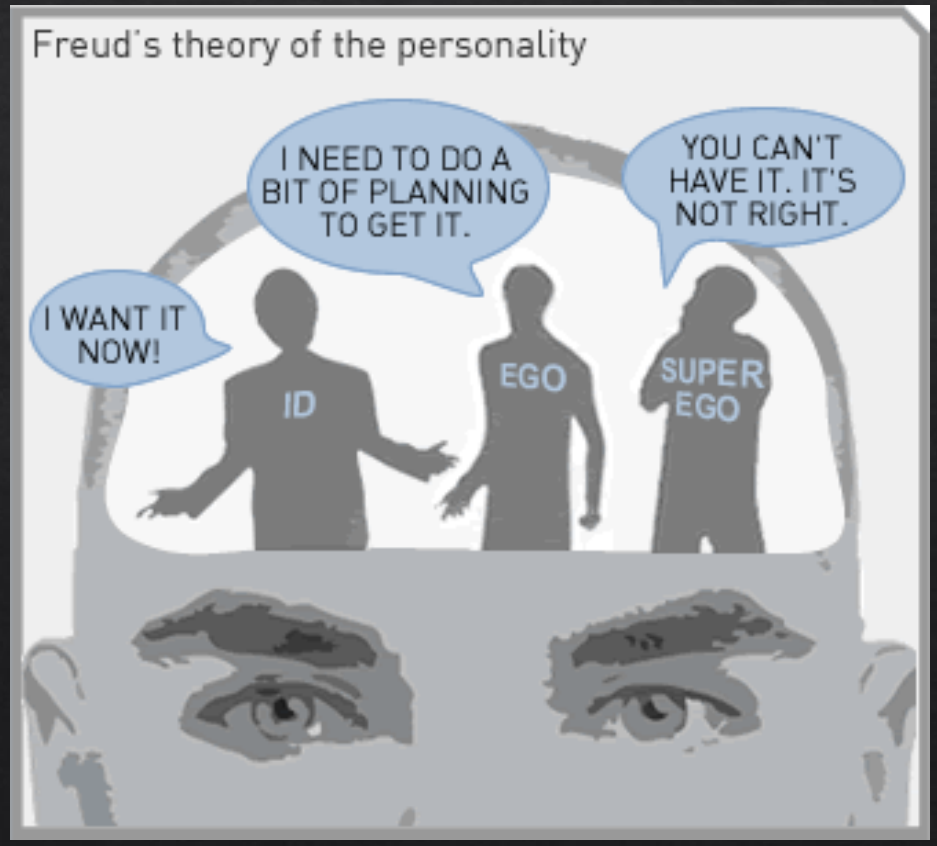
PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY

- The ego refers to the "I" and works on the reality principle, controls the Id, and can delay pleasure.
- The ego can conform with existing societal consideration.



PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY

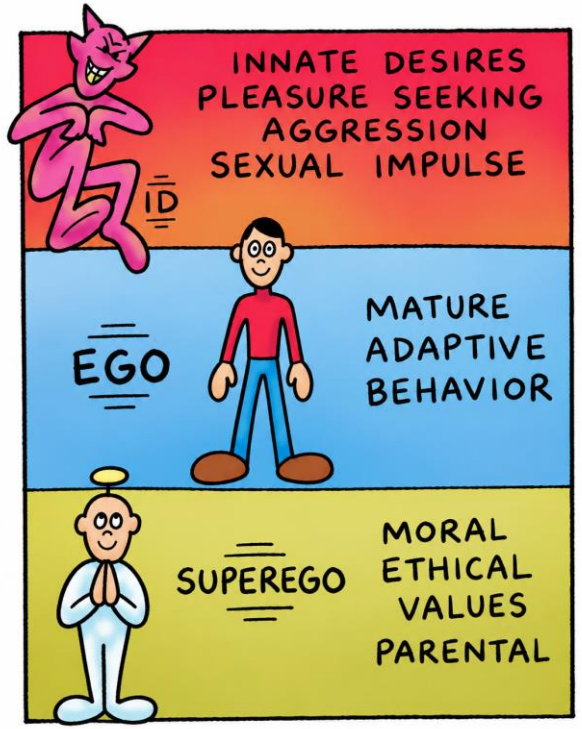
- The superego refers to the "conscience" and "moral judge" of conduct.
- Violation of rules lead to guilt feelings.
- It strives for perfection rather than pleasure.



PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY

- It appears that the id is the devil within the self, the superego is the angel, and ego is the person in the middle.
- The id, ego, and superego are often in conflict with each other.

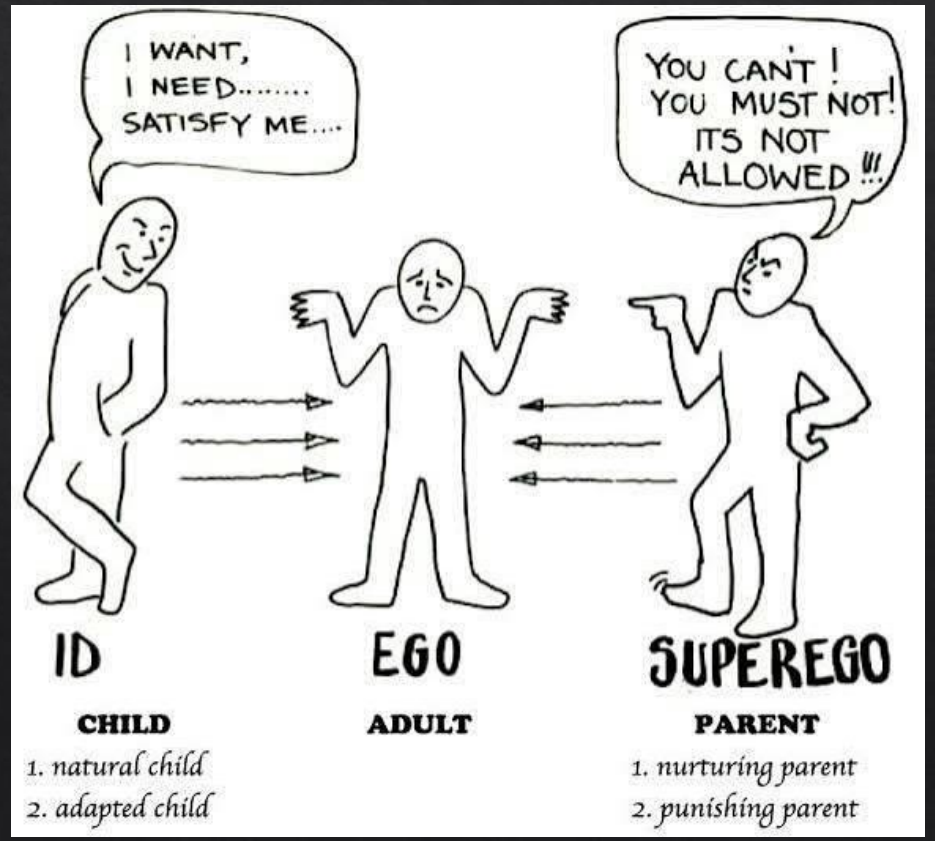
- Id: energy striving to satisfy basic drives
- Ego: Seeks to gratify the id in realistic ways
- Superego: voice of conscious that emphasizes how we *ought* to behave



Freud's components of personality

PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY

- Freud used the term ego strength to refer to the ego's ability to resolve the conflict between the three structures.
- If thus constant state of conflict is unresolved, personality problems may arise.



- UNCONSCIOUS

- SATISFACTION OF BASIC NEEDS

- PLEASURE PRINCIPLE

- IMMEDIATE GRATIFICATION

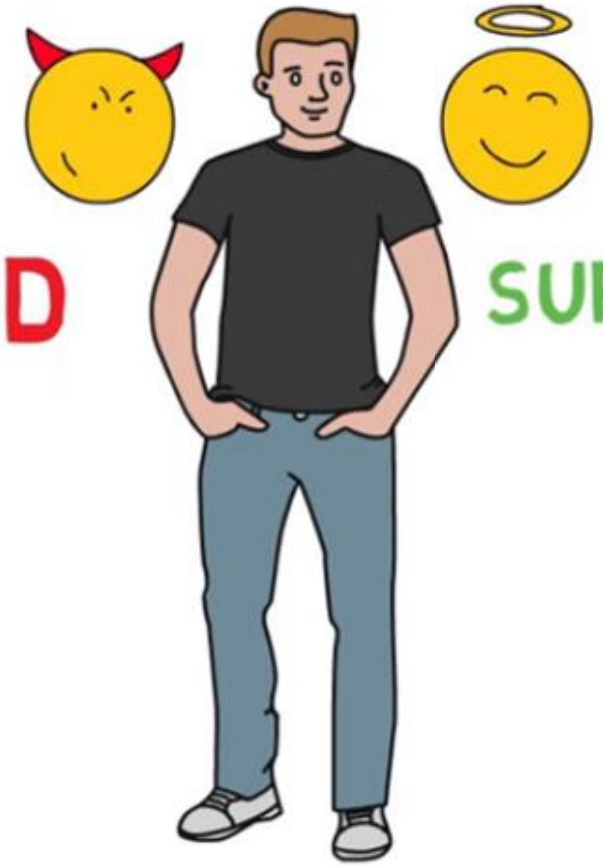


- CONSCIOUS

- REALITY PRINCIPLE

- MEDIATOR BETWEEN ID AND SUPEREGO

EGO



ID

SUPEREGO

- MOSTLY UNCONSCIOUS

- MORAL PRINCIPLE

- RIGHT AND WRONG

- RULES, MORAL AND NORMS



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

SUBSCRIBE

"THIS IS BORING"

"WHY AM I DOING THIS?"



"DOING MY HOMEWORK
IS THE RIGHT THING TO DO"

"I SHOULD DO IT
FOR MY CAREER"

REWARD VERSUS PUNISHMENT



EGO

"THIS HOMEWORK IS A BIT BORING AND I WANT TO DO SOMETHING MORE PLEASURABLE
BUT IF I DON'T MAKE IT, I MIGHT FAIL MY EXAM OR MY CLASS"

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.
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PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- In Freud's view, the id, ego, and superego develop in a series of stages.
- Freud called these psychosexual stages of development that progresses through five (5) stages.

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Psychosexual Stages of Development

Personality Development Theory by Sigmund Freud

1. Oral Stage
Birth to 1 year



2. Anal Stage
1 year to 3 years



3. Phallic Stage
3 years to 6 years



4. Latent Stage
6 years to Puberty



5. Genital Stage
Puberty to Adulthood



PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- Each of the stage is associated with conflicts that the individual must resolve so that he or she can successfully forward to the next stage.

- Freud also believed that each stage has needs, and dissatisfaction of needs may result in fixation which could have lasting negative effects on personality.

STAGE	AGE RANGE	EROGENOUS ZONE	KEY CONFLICT	POSSIBLE OUTCOME IF FIXATED
1 ORAL	Birth – 18 months	Mouth	Weaning from breastfeeding / bottle-feeding	• Smoking • Overeating • Nail-biting • Excessive dependency
2 ANAL	18 months – 3 years	Anus	Toilet training	May result in: • **Anal-retentive**: overly neat, organized, stubborn • **Anal-expulsive**: messy, careless, rebellious
3 PHALLIC	3 – 6 years	Genitals	Identification with same-sex parent	• Development of the superego (moral conscience) • Possible relationship and identity difficulties
4 LATENCY	6 years – Puberty	Sexual impulses dormant	Social, intellectual, and skill development	• Sexual urges are largely repressed • Energy directed toward school, friendships, hobbies, social skills
5 GENITAL	Puberty onward	Genitals	Development of mature relationships	• Sexual interests reawaken in mature form • Healthy, loving relationships • Well-balanced adult personality

FIXATION

If unresolved conflict or frustration occurs at a stage, a person may become "fixed" there, influencing later behavior and personality.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- The first stage is the oral stage, which lasts from birth up to the first year of life.
- During this stage, babies derive pleasure from oral activities like sucking and biting.
- Overindulgence of the oral needs may lead to oral incorporative personality disorder such as overeating, smoking, and alcoholism while dissatisfaction may lead to oral aggressive personality disorder such as sarcasm and tactlessness.

1 ORAL STAGE (Birth–18 Months)



The mouth is the primary source of pleasure and satisfaction.

Pleasure comes from sucking, biting, and swallowing.

The infant depends on caregivers for nourishment.

Fixation may result in behaviors such as:

- **Smoking**
- **Nail-biting**
- **Overeating**
- **Excessive dependency**

NOTE: If needs are not satisfied, or are gratified too much or too little, fixation may affect later personality.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- The next stage is anal stage, which occurs around the second year of life.
- During this stage, the child derives pleasure from the elimination of body wastes. Through toilet training, the child learns the basic rules of society.
- Anal fixations can lead to anal retentive personality disorder such as obsession with cleanliness or anal expulsion personality disorder such as clumsiness.

2 ANAL STAGE (18 Months–3 Years)



KEY TASK:
Learning bowel and bladder control



Pleasure focuses on bowel and bladder control.



Toilet training is the major developmental task.

FIXATION MAY PRODUCE:

ANAL-RETENTIVE

Overly neat, organized, stubborn.

- Very orderly
- Perfectionist
- Inflexible
- Stubborn

ANAL-EXPULSIVE

Messy, careless, rebellious.

- Disorganized
- Careless
- Impulsive
- Defiant

NOTE: Successful completion supports a sense of personal control and self-discipline.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- Freud called the third stage, phallic stage, that usually occurs around the ages of 3 and 6.
- Children during this stage derive pleasure from examining, touching, fondling, or displaying their genitals, or others.
- These behaviors are likely motivated by curiosity on the differences between the anatomy of man and woman.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- Sex curiosity will remain high during the elementary years and children tend to ask questions with regard to anatomical structures, sex, and how babies are made.
- During this stage, parents and teachers need to properly educate the children about sexuality.
- Fixations at this stage may lead to abnormal sex behaviors in later life.

3 PHALLIC STAGE (3–6 Years)





Children become aware of their genitals.



Freud proposed the Oedipus complex (boys) and Electra complex (girls [a concept later developed by others]).



Successful resolution involves identification with the same-sex parent and development of the superego.

OEDIPUS COMPLEX

Boy develops unconscious attraction toward his mother and rivalry with his father.

Resolution: identifies with father and adopts his values.

ELECTRA COMPLEX

Girl develops unconscious attraction toward her father and rivalry with her mother.

Resolution: identifies with mother and adopts her values.

OUTCOME: Successful resolution of this stage leads to: healthy self-identity, positive relationships, and development of the superego (moral conscience).

OEDIPUS COMPLEX

A term proposed by Sigmund Freud describing a young boy's unconscious desire for his mother and rivalry toward his father.

During the phallic stage (3–6 years), a boy develops unconscious attraction toward his mother and sees his father as a rival for her love and attention.

- The boy idealizes and desires his mother.
- He feels jealous of his father.
- He fears punishment (classically described as castration anxiety).
- To resolve the conflict, he identifies with his father.
- He internalizes his father's values and develops the superego.

When successfully resolved:

- Accepts father as a role model.
- Develops a strong superego.
- Forms healthier relationships in the future.

Freud believed that resolving the Oedipus complex was an important step in a boy's emotional and moral development.

Oedipus = Desire for Mother + Rivalry with Father + Resolution through Identification.

ELECTRA COMPLEX

A psychoanalytic concept describing a young girl's subconscious attachment to her father and accompanying rivalry with her mother.

During the phallic stage (around 3–6 years), a girl develops unconscious feelings of love and attachment toward her father.

She may see her mother as a rival for her father's love and attention.

- Desires to be special in her father's life.
- May feel jealous of her mother.
- May experience guilt or fear of losing her father's love.
- Resolves the conflict by identifying with her mother.

When successfully resolved:

- Healthy relationship with mother.
- Adopts mother's values and behaviors.
- Develops feminine identity.
- Develops a strong superego.

The Electra complex is an important part of the traditional psychoanalytic account of a girl's psychosexual development. Its resolution was theorized to contribute to emotional maturity, self-identity, and later relationships.

Electra = Love for Father + Rivalry with Mother + Identification with Mother.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- The fourth stage is the latency stage, which lasts from 7 to 12.
- At this stage, sexual energy is repressed because children become busy with school.

4 LATENCY STAGE (6 Years–Puberty)



Sexual urges are largely repressed.

Energy is directed toward school, friendships, hobbies, and social skills.

School • Friendships • Hobbies • Social Skills

Personality and social development continue.

NOTE:

During this stage, children focus on learning, building relationships, and developing skills. They prepare for the physical and emotional changes of adolescence.

PSYCHOSEXUAL STAGES

- The last stage is genital stage, which starts from adolescence to adulthood.
- During this stage, pleasure is again derived from the genital area and individuals seek to satisfy their sexual drives from sexual relationships.
- Sexual problems may result as a consequence of inappropriate sex behaviors.

5 GENITAL STAGE (Puberty–Adulthood)



Sexual interests reawaken in a mature form.

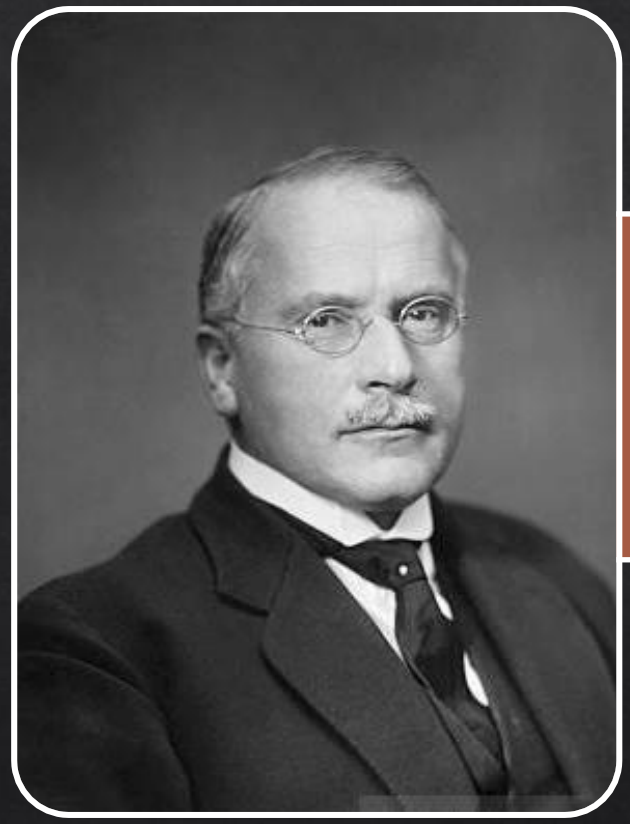
Individuals seek healthy romantic and sexual relationships.

Successful completion supports a well-balanced adult personality.

FOCUS:
Building mature relationships and living responsibly.

Individuals form meaningful relationships, build a career, and contribute positively to society.

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Carl Jung:

Self as Central Archetype

THE SELF AS THE CENTRAL ARCHETYPE

- The psyche continues to develop throughout life, but the psyche starts to show a definite form and content during adolescence.
- Jung conceived the structure of personality (psyche) as a complex network of interacting systems that strive toward harmony.
- The main systems are:
    1. ego,
    2. personal unconscious, and
    3. collective unconscious

THE SELF AS THE CENTRAL ARCHETYPE

EGO

The ego is one's conscious mind, the part of the psyche that includes perceptions, thoughts, feelings, and memories that may enter consciousness.

It is through ego that we establish sense of stability.

PERSONAL UNCONSCIOUS

Personal unconscious includes the repressed and unforgotten experiences.

COLLECTIVE UNCONSCIOUS

Collective unconscious consists of the fundamental elements of the human psyche that includes experiences all humans share or in common.

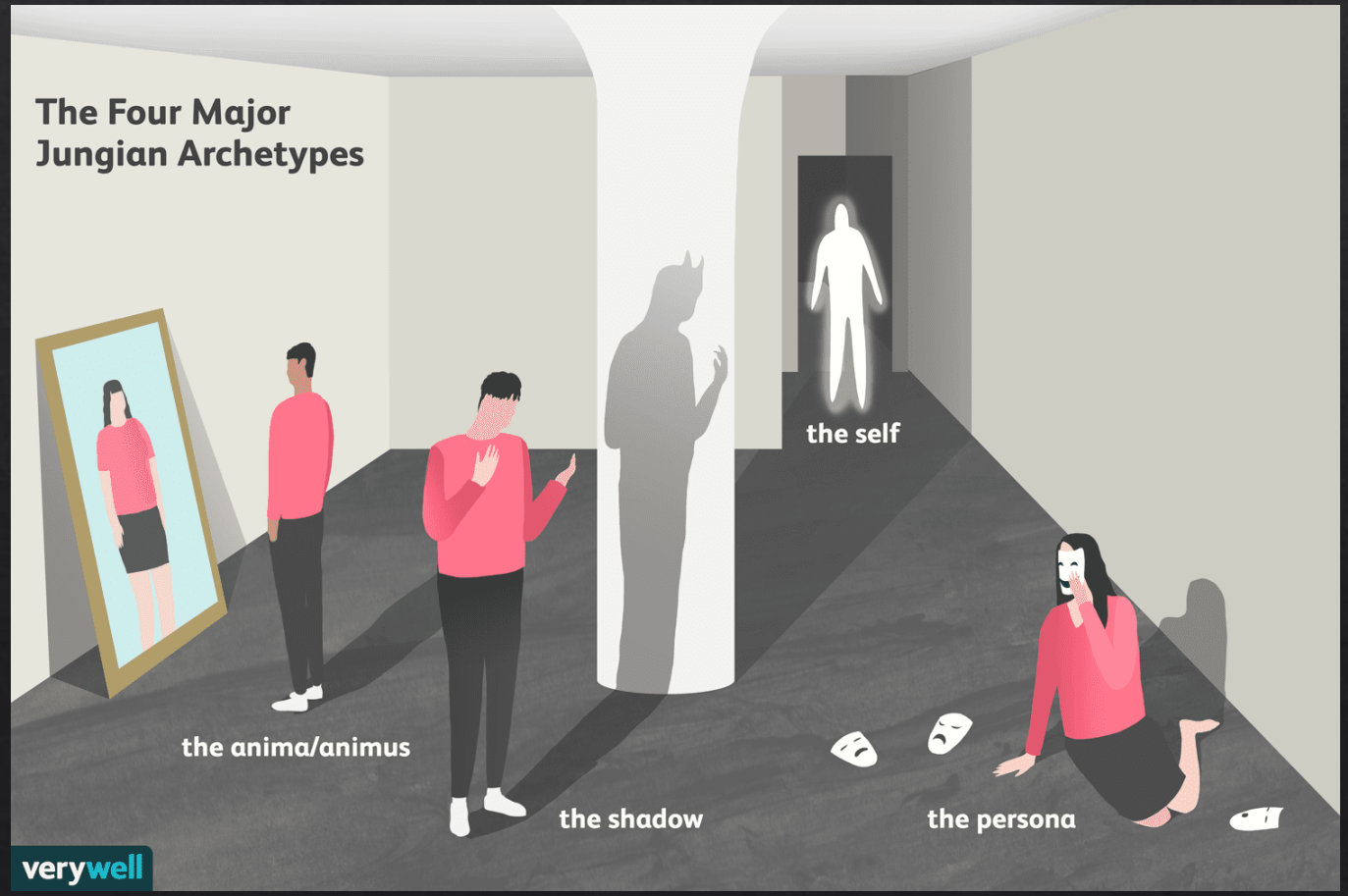
THE SELF AS THE CENTRAL ARCHETYPE

- Within the collective unconscious lie the archetypes.
- Central to Carl Jung's theory of the self is the concept of archetype.
- An archetype is a universal thought form or predisposition to respond to the world in certain ways.
- The archetype represents the hidden potentialities of the psyche, or total personality.

THE SELF AS THE CENTRAL ARCHETYPE

For Jung, there are four major archetypes:

1. Persona
2. Shadow
3. Animus/Anima, and
4. Self



THE SELF AS THE CENTRAL ARCHETYPE

PERSONA

- The persona refers to social roles that individuals present to others.

SHADOW

- The shadow refers to the repressed thoughts that are unacceptable. This archetype is considered as the dark side of the psyche.

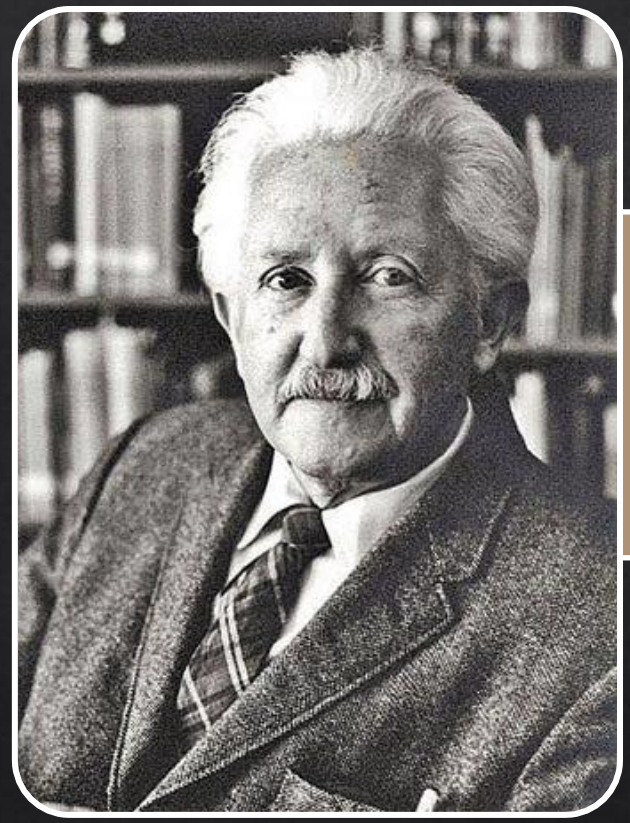
ANIMA / ANIMUS

- The anima is the feminine side of the male psyche while the animus is the masculine side of the female psyche.

SELF

- The self is the central archetype that unites all parts of the psyche. The ego is the individual's conscious perception of the self.

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Erik Erickson:

Psychosocial Theory

PSYCHOSOCIAL THEORY

- Another important aspect of self-understanding involves views of identity development of the self.
- In Erik Erikson's theory, adolescence stage is a period of identity development.
- Identity formation is usually viewed as a process that requires adolescents to distance themselves from the strong expectations and definitions imposed by parents and other family members.

PSYCHOSOCIAL THEORY

- To achieve an individual identity, one must create a vision of the self that is authentic and having hold of one's destiny in an effort to reach goals that are personally meaningful.
- Erikson's theory proposes that individuals go through eight psychosocial stages of development.
- While Erikson believed that each stage is important, he gave a particular emphasis on the development of the ego.

ERIKSON'S 8 STAGES OF PSYCHOSOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

STAGE	AGE	PSYCHOSOCIAL CONFLICT	BASIC VIRTUE	DESCRIPTION
1	0–1 year	**Trust vs. Mistrust**	**Hope**	Infants learn to trust caregivers to meet their basic needs.
2	1–3 years	**Autonomy vs. Shame & Doubt**	**Will**	Toddlers develop a sense of personal control and independence.
3	3–6 years	**Initiative vs. Guilt**	**Purpose**	Children assert control through directing play and social interactions.
4	6–12 years	**Industry vs. Inferiority**	**Competence**	Children develop a sense of pride in accomplishments and abilities.
5	12–18 years	**Identity vs. Role Confusion**	**Fidelity**	Teens explore personal identity and sense of self.
6	18–40 years	**Intimacy vs. Isolation**	**Love**	Young adults form intimate, loving relationships with others.
7	40–65 years	**Generativity vs. Stagnation**	**Care**	Adults create or nurture things that will outlast them, contributing to society.
8	65+ years	**Ego Integrity vs. Despair**	**Wisdom**	Seniors reflect on life and either feel a sense of fulfillment or regret.

Each stage presents a psychosocial conflict that contributes to personality and social development.